WORK PRACTICE / RESEARCH EDITION

The Distributed Work Report 2026

Six findings for a clearer team agreement.

On-site Hybrid Remote

01	Meeting load	02	Focus time
03	Decision records	04	First-month support
05	Late handoffs	06	Location preference

600 synthetic records.
Three work arrangements.
One traceable data model.

AYOBAMI / PUBLICATION DESIGN

READING ROUTE

Start with the question.

Read the summary, inspect a finding, then return to the counts behind the chart.

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Practices deserve a closer look.

This report is an illustrative research publication. Its 600 records were constructed, not collected from people.

55%	54.3%	58.3%
prefer hybrid	have a focus window	can find decisions
330 / 600	326 / 600	350 / 600

The example separates work arrangement from meeting load, protected focus, decision clarity, onboarding support and delayed handoffs. None of the differences establish that location caused the result.

Use the findings as prompts for a working agreement. Choose a practice, define a measurable signal and review the same team over a stated period. Check the appendix before relying on a headline.

EVIDENCE STATUS / Synthetic scenario; descriptive counts only. No population estimate, statistical significance or independent assurance is claimed.

A model for reading evidence carefully.

A fixed synthetic dataset makes every visual traceable and every denominator visible.

The dataset contains 600 invented respondent records. Current arrangements are divided equally: 200 on-site, 200 hybrid and 200 remote. This balance was chosen for comparison; it does not represent a labour market.

Each record contains one meeting-hours band, four binary flags and a preferred arrangement. Category totals were fixed before record generation. A seeded shuffle distributes the values within each group. There are no missing responses, weights or repeated waves.

No survey was conducted. No employer, participant or research institution supplied these records. The reference week and first-month support measures are illustrative definitions.

The source file respondents.csv contains one row per record. aggregates.json is calculated from those rows and supplies the native charts. The appendix presents the counts used in the six findings.

Binary rates use 200 as the denominator within each current-arrangement group. Preference totals use all 600 records. Percentage-point differences subtract rates directly. Combined percentages are rounded to one decimal place where needed.

Independent shuffles do not create meaningful respondent-level relationships. Do not use these records to fit a prediction model or infer associations between flags. Their purpose is transparent publication design.

REPRODUCTION / Seed 20261008. Exact category counts are fixed in prepare-distributed.py; aggregate outputs are reconciled before layout.

Know the sample. Know the boundary.

Equal group sizes help a reader compare rates, but they do not make the example representative.

Current arrangement	Records	Share
On-site	200	33.3%
Hybrid	200	33.3%
Remote	200	33.3%
Total	600	100%

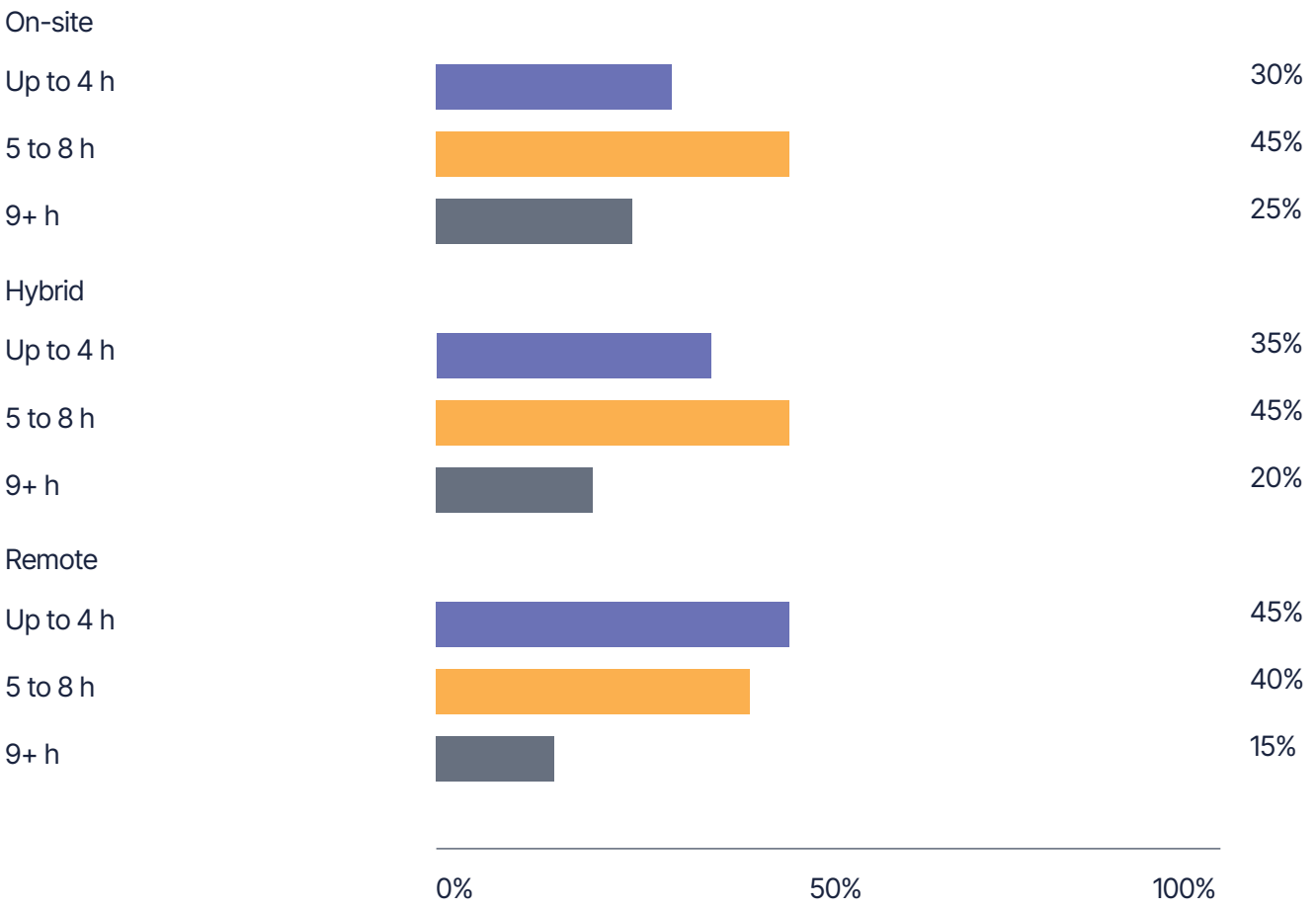
USEFUL FOR
Tracing a chart to a count, comparing denominators and reviewing an evidence-led publication system.

UNSUITABLE FOR
Population estimates, workplace rankings, causal claims or policy decisions based on this example alone.

ROUNDING / Three displayed shares of 33.3% sum to 99.9%. The total remains 100%; unrounded values are one third each.

Meeting load is a coordination choice.

Weekly meeting hours. Base: 200 records per current-arrangement group.



SOURCE / F1 in appendix A, page 20. Synthetic descriptive counts.

45%

of remote records sit in the lowest meeting band.

The meeting bands describe three different distributions in a deliberately constructed sample. Sixty of 200 on-site records, 70 of 200 hybrid records and 90 of 200 remote records fall in the up-to-four-hour band. The highest band contains 50, 40 and 30 records respectively.

The difference is useful as a design prompt. A team could examine which meetings transfer information, which require discussion and which make decisions. A recurring meeting should have a stated purpose and a clear output. Location alone does not tell a manager whether a meeting is useful.

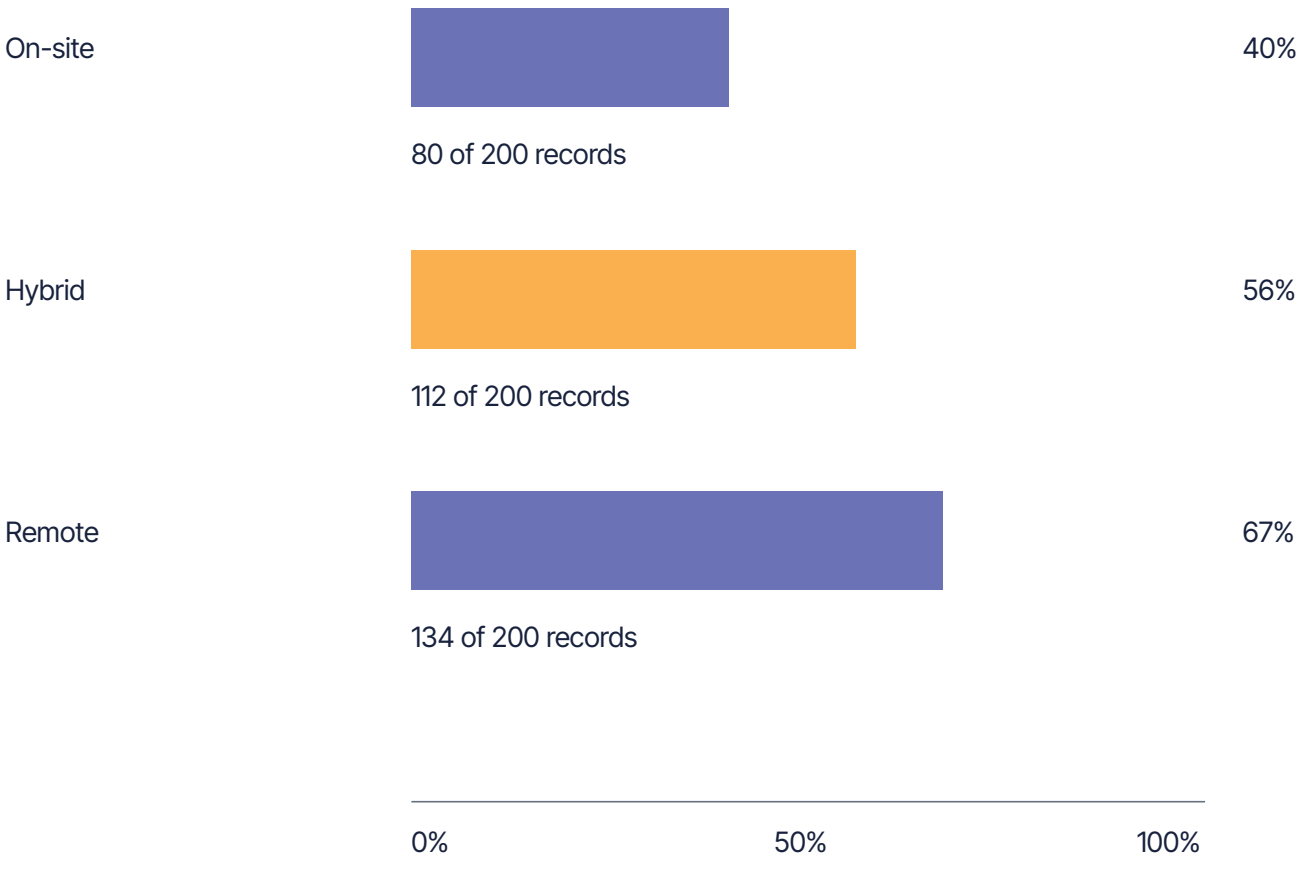
This example does not establish that remote work reduces meeting time. The records were constructed with these counts; no participants were recruited and no hours were measured. The categories also hide variation within each band. Four hours and one hour appear in the same category.

For a real trial, use a consistent diary period and define what counts as a meeting. Include recurring calls, impromptu discussions and scheduled reviews. Compare workload and role before interpreting differences. Start with one team agreement, then review whether the agreement improves clarity without moving the same coordination burden into messages.

TRY / Give one recurring meeting a written purpose, owner and expected decision. Review it after four weeks.

Protect time to finish the work.

Protected two-hour focus window on four days. Base: 200 records per current-arrangement group.



SOURCE / F2 in appendix A, page 20. Synthetic descriptive counts.

27 pp

separates remote and on-site focus-window rates.

The protected-focus flag is set for 80 on-site, 112 hybrid and 134 remote records. With 200 records in each group, those counts become 40%, 56% and 67%. Across the whole sample, 326 of 600 records carry the flag, or 54.3% when rounded to one decimal place.

A protected window means a planned two-hour block available on at least four days in the defined week. It does not mean the block was uninterrupted, productive or suitable for every role. Customer support, care work and operational coverage may need different arrangements.

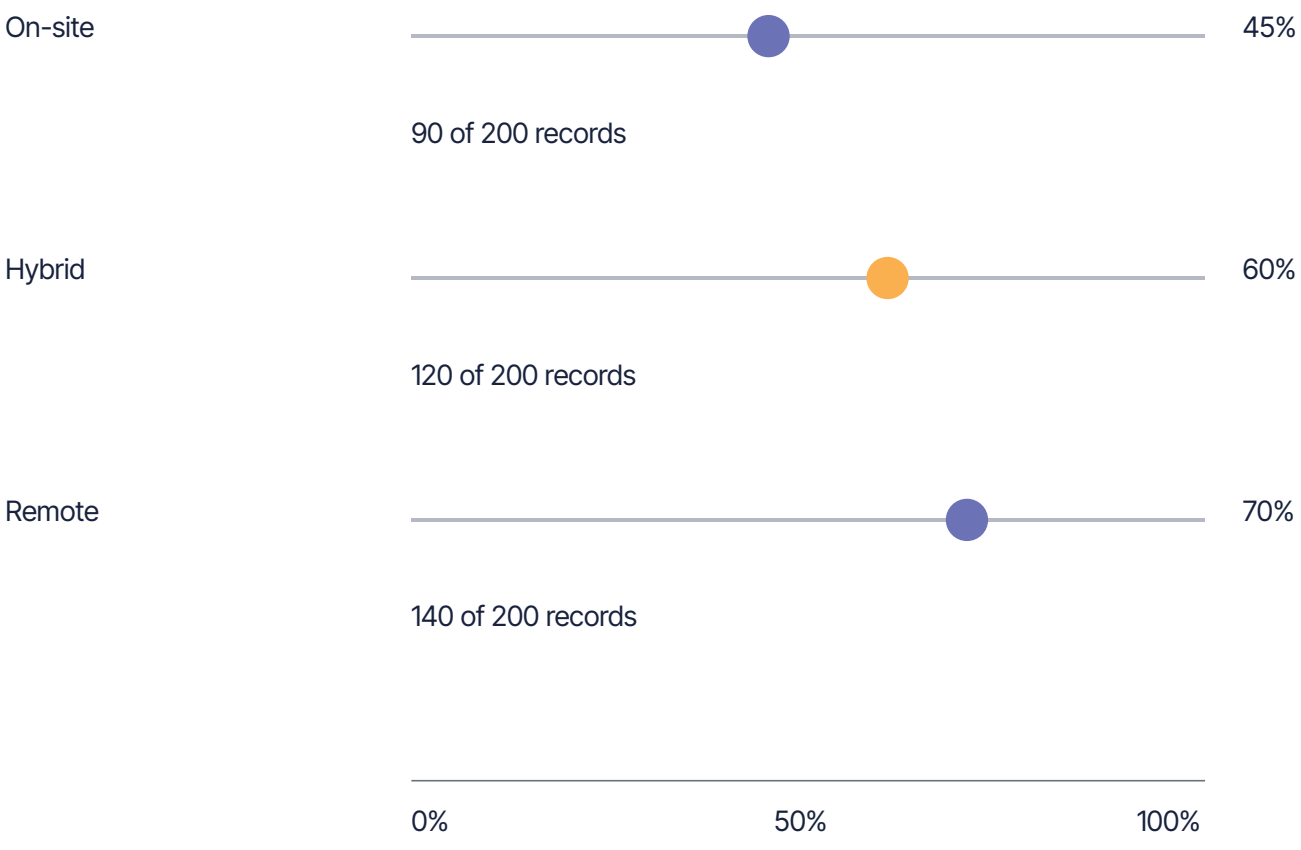
The 27-percentage-point gap is a description of the constructed groups, not an estimate of an effect. A percentage point is the difference between two rates: 67% minus 40%. It is not a 27% relative increase.

A manager can use the example to ask a practical question: where can the team reserve finishing time without leaving essential work uncovered? Agree on the window, the exceptions and the person handling urgent contact. Record completion and interruptions separately. Avoid treating a calendar block as evidence of output quality. Compare the same tasks over time before changing the agreement.

TRY / Schedule one protected block with a coverage rule. Record interruptions separately from task completion.

Write decisions where people look.

Decisions easy to find in a shared record. Base: 200 records per current-arrangement group.



SOURCE / F3 in appendix A, page 20. Synthetic descriptive counts.

70%

of remote records have a positive decision-clarity flag.

Written-decision clarity is positive for 90 on-site, 120 hybrid and 140 remote records. The corresponding rates are 45%, 60% and 70%. The combined count is 350 of 600 records, or 58.3%. These values describe access to a decision record, not agreement with the decision.

A useful record states the decision, the owner, the date and the next action. It also identifies the material that informed the choice. One shared location can reduce repeated searching, provided people know when a decision belongs there and who updates it.

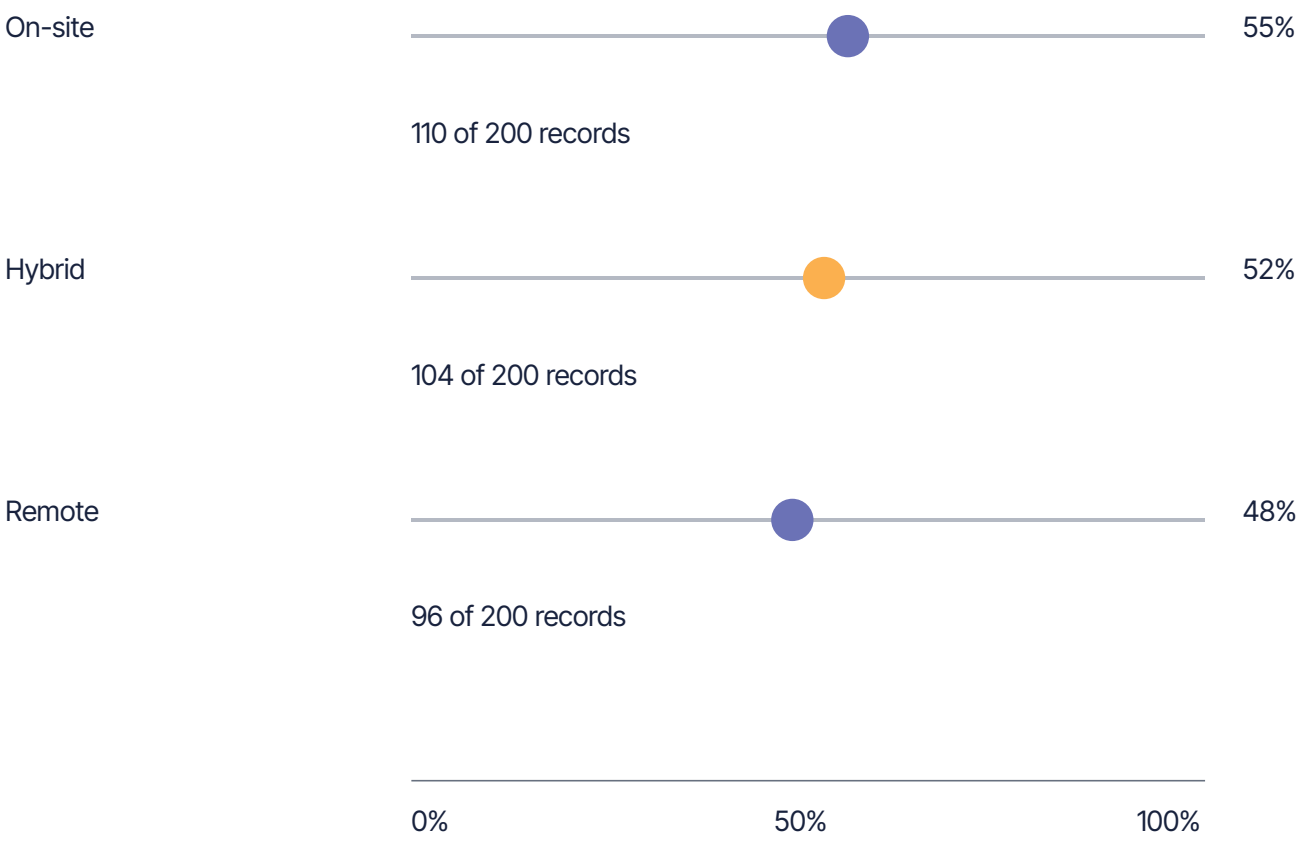
The flag does not measure the quality of the decision or the accessibility of the tool. It also does not show whether readers understood the consequences. In a real study, those would require separate questions or observation.

Begin with a small convention for consequential decisions. Use plain titles and predictable dates. Link supporting material rather than copying it into several channels. Keep a record of changes when a decision is revised. Review whether new team members can find an example without asking the original decision maker. The test is retrieval and comprehension, not the volume of documentation created.

TRY / Publish one decision using four fields: decision, owner, date and next action. Ask a colleague to locate it.

Onboarding needs an available person.

Support available during the first month. Base: 200 records per current-arrangement group.



SOURCE / F4 in appendix A, page 20. Synthetic descriptive counts.

48%

of remote records carry the positive support flag.

Support during the first month is positive for 110 on-site, 104 hybrid and 96 remote records: 55%, 52% and 48%. The range is narrower than the focus-window example. The whole-sample count is 310 of 600, or 51.7%.

The flag describes a hypothetical report of available support. It does not measure time to competence, retention or satisfaction. A named contact and a predictable check-in can make support easier to request, but this dataset cannot establish how well those practices work.

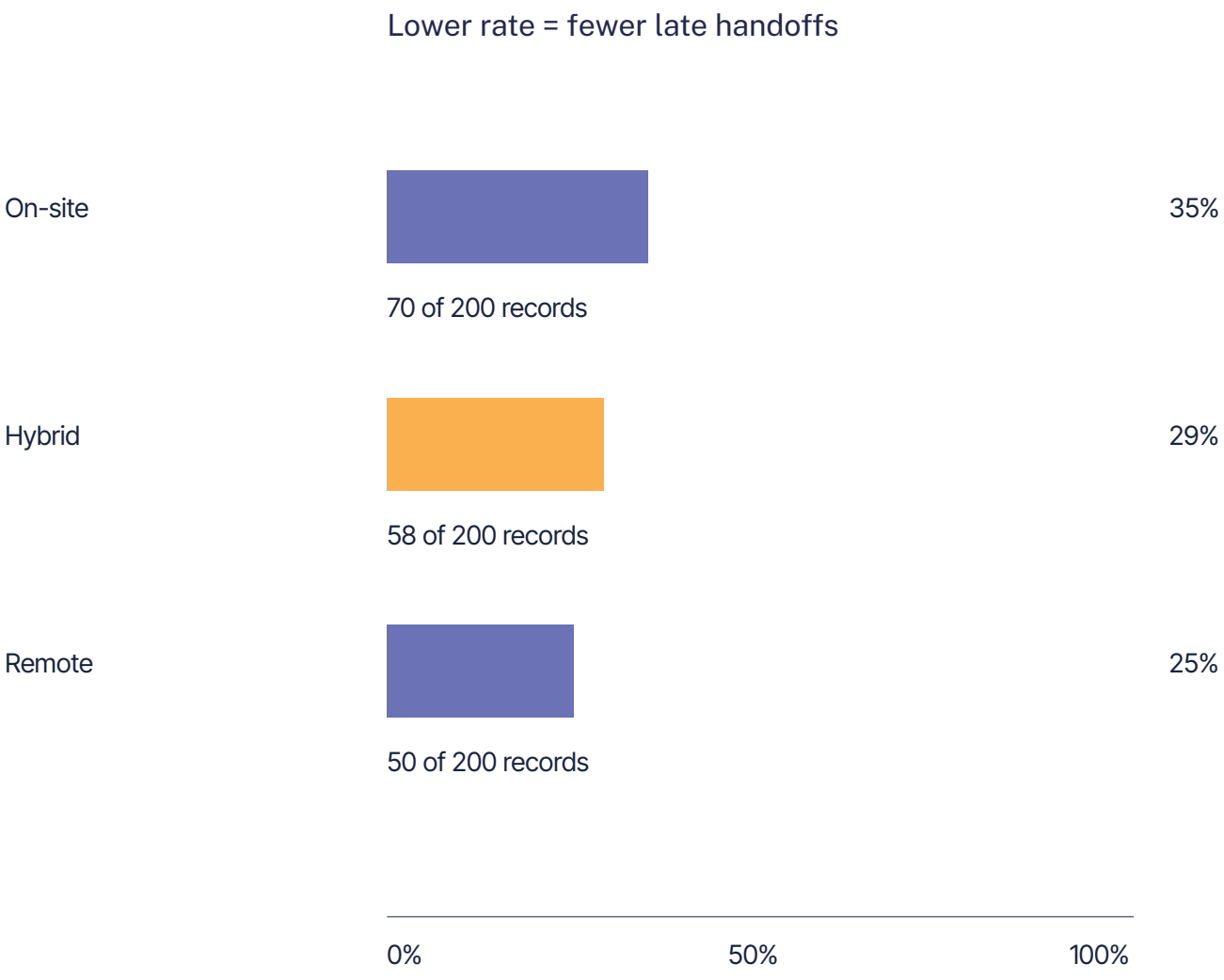
A real onboarding review should define when the first month starts, which support channels count and whether a response arrived in time. A document repository is not automatically a substitute for a person who can explain local context.

Separate access to information from access to help. Prepare a short starting route, then give the newcomer a named contact and a backup. Ask about the first blocked task rather than sending only a broad satisfaction question. Review the experience at agreed intervals. Different roles and levels of prior experience may need different measures, so avoid ranking teams from this single flag.

TRY / Name a primary and backup contact. Record the first blocked task and the time taken to get useful help.

Make the handoff visible before it slips.

Late handoff reported in the reference week. Base: 200 records per current-arrangement group.



SOURCE / F5 in appendix A, page 20. Synthetic descriptive counts.

25%

of remote records have the late-handoff flag.

The late-handoff flag is positive for 70 on-site, 58 hybrid and 50 remote records: 35%, 29% and 25%. Across the sample, 178 of 600 records are positive, or 29.7%. A lower value here describes fewer hypothetical late handoffs; it is not an overall performance score.

A handoff needs a recipient, an expected output and a usable due time. Visibility helps people notice that the next person cannot start. The flag alone cannot distinguish a missing input, an unrealistic deadline or a competing urgent task.

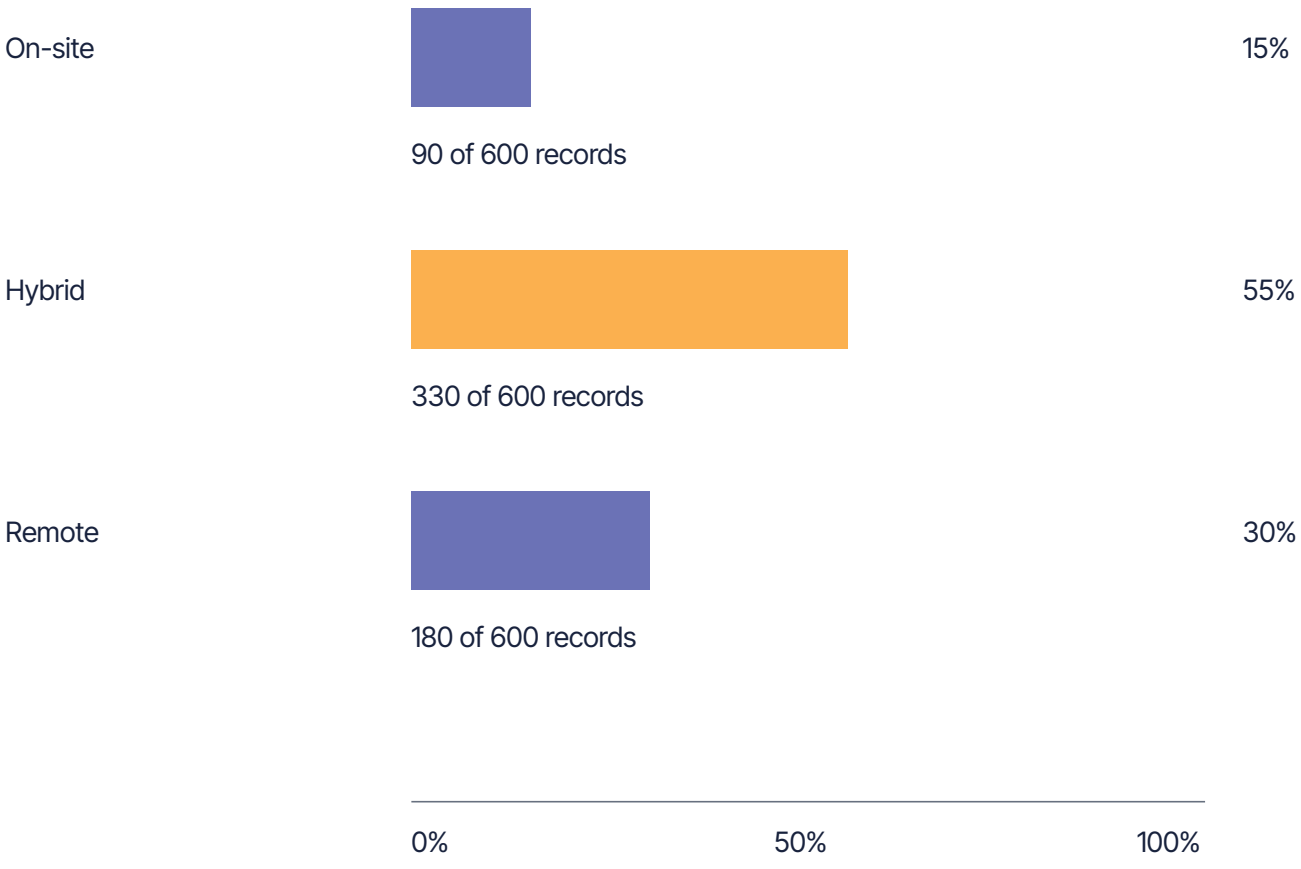
The reference week is an invented measurement period. These records do not demonstrate a relationship between work location and delivery reliability. The definition also counts respondents with a late handoff, not the number of delayed tasks.

In a real trial, keep those denominators separate. Track completed handoffs, delayed handoffs and people affected. State the due time and the time zone when teams work across regions. Use a small escalation rule before the deadline passes. Investigate the reason for a delay with the people involved; a status marker is an invitation to coordinate, not a complete explanation.

TRY / Add recipient, due time and next action to one handoff. Agree when to flag a risk before the due time.

Preference is a starting conversation.

Preferred arrangement across all 600 records. Base: all 600 records.



SOURCE / F6 in appendix B, page 21. Synthetic descriptive counts.

55%

of the synthetic sample prefers a hybrid arrangement.

The preference totals are 90 on-site, 330 hybrid and 180 remote records. Dividing by all 600 records gives 15%, 55% and 30%. The appendix matrix shows how these totals are distributed across current arrangements, with each row containing 200 records.

A preference is not a statement that a particular arrangement is feasible for every job. The example deliberately separates current arrangement from desired arrangement. Combining the two into one label would hide whether people are expressing satisfaction, a wish for change or a conditional choice.

The matrix is constructed, not observed. No confidence interval, population estimate or causal conclusion is appropriate. Equal current-arrangement groups were chosen to make comparisons readable; they do not describe the distribution of work arrangements in any country or industry.

For a real conversation, ask what conditions would make an arrangement workable: tasks, coverage, access to equipment and opportunities to learn. Explain the constraints before collecting a preference. Avoid presenting a majority choice as a complete operating policy. Pair preferences with a trial plan and a clear review date, then compare experience against the practices the team agreed to test.

TRY / Ask for preferred arrangement and the conditions behind it. Keep that answer separate from current location.

Write a small working agreement.

Choose practices that the team can observe. The synthetic findings are prompts, not prescriptions.



01 / Protect finishing time

Name the focus block, coverage arrangement and urgent-contact exception. Track interruptions separately from completion.



02 / Record consequential decisions

Use one shared place and a short convention: decision, owner, date and next action. Test whether a newcomer can retrieve an example.



03 / Make support explicit

Give a new colleague a primary contact and a backup. Ask about the first blocked task and whether help arrived in time.



04 / Define the handoff

State the recipient, expected output and usable due time. Agree how early to raise a risk before the deadline passes.

KEEP LOCATION SEPARATE / Record current arrangement and preference as context. Neither is a complete measure of how the team coordinates.

Run a trial you can explain.

A four-week review can make a working agreement more concrete. Set the question before measuring the result.

Before	Choose one practice and define its signal. State the team, tasks, measurement period and coverage constraints.
Week 1	Record a baseline with the same definition you will use later. Explain the record to the people affected.
Weeks 2-3	Try the agreement. Keep a short log of exceptions and unexpected costs; avoid changing the definition halfway through.
Week 4	Compare the signal with the baseline and discuss the experience. Keep, revise or stop the practice, with a stated reason.

REVIEW QUESTIONS / What improved? What became harder? Who was excluded by the agreement? What should remain unchanged in the next trial?

The numbers behind the findings.

All binary entries below are positive-flag counts. Rates divide by 200 within each group. Meeting bands also use 200.

Measure	On-site	Hybrid	Remote
F1 / Up to 4 meeting hours	60	70	90
F1 / 5 to 8 meeting hours	90	90	80
F1 / 9+ meeting hours	50	40	30
F2 / Protected focus	80	112	134
F3 / Decision clarity	90	120	140
F4 / Onboarding support	110	104	96
F5 / Late handoff	70	58	50
Group denominator	200	200	200

TRACE / respondents.csv → aggregates.json → native chart geometry. Negative binary flags equal 200 minus each positive count.

Current and preferred are separate fields.

Rows show current arrangement. Columns show preferred arrangement. Each current-arrangement group contains 200 records.

Current / preferred	On-site	Hybrid	Remote
On-site	80	90	30
Hybrid	10	150	40
Remote	0	90	110
Column total	90	330	180

CHECK THE ROWS
80 + 90 + 30 = 200
10 + 150 + 40 = 200
0 + 90 + 110 = 200

CHECK THE TOTAL
90 + 330 + 180 = 600
15% + 55% + 30% = 100%
Preference chart: page 16.

SCENARIO BOUNDARY / This matrix was constructed. It does not describe a real workforce, country or organisation.

Be precise about what a flag means.

Each definition belongs to this synthetic scenario. A real study would need a collection protocol and participant context.

Meeting-hours band	Up to 4, 5 to 8, or 9 or more hours in an invented reference week. These are categories, not precise durations.
Protected focus	A planned two-hour focus window on at least four days of that week; not a measure of achieved output.
Decision clarity	A positive flag for decisions being easy to find in a shared record; not a score for decision quality.
Onboarding support	A positive flag for support being available in the first month; no time-to-competence claim is made.
Late handoff	At least one reported late handoff in the reference week; counts people, not delayed tasks.
Preference	One desired arrangement recorded separately from current arrangement; not a feasibility assessment.

SOURCE / Original synthetic dataset and editorial text for this publication. No external empirical study is cited or represented. Font licences: SIL OFL, included in FONTS.

Turn the page into a useful question.

Publication design by Ayobami. This report demonstrates a native editorial system with traceable charts and live data tables.

The report combines a reading route, six paired findings, practical recommendations and two data appendices. All charts are native InDesign shapes with live labels. The source pack includes the 600-row CSV, aggregate JSON, content and production scripts.

The example is intended to show how evidence can be organised clearly. It is not a workplace survey, consulting assessment or endorsement from an employer. An accessible publication also requires manual review of reading order and table interpretation; a tagged export alone is not a conformance claim.

A useful next step is to replace the example with a real, permitted dataset. Preserve definitions and denominators, then adjust the charts to match the source. Record missing responses and limitations rather than concealing them in a headline.

For publication enquiries, prepare the intended reader, source material, page count, delivery format and review date. These details make the scope concrete.

PUBLICATION ENQUIRIES / publications@distributed-work.example

WORK PRACTICE / RESEARCH EDITION

Better questions. Clearer agreements.

Six findings. One traceable example.

Return to the counts, keep the definitions visible, and choose a practice the team can test.